



English Extension 1

**General
Instructions**

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 2 hours
- Write using black pen

**Total marks:
50**

Section I – 25 marks (pages 3–7)

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section II – 25 marks (page 8)

- Attempt Question 2
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section I: Common Module — Literary Worlds

25 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question demonstrating control of the use of language
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Question 1: Critical response (25 marks)

Use **Text 1** and **Text 2** to answer this question.

Evaluate how effectively, and to what purpose, Christopher Nolan constructs the world of his protagonist, Batman/Bruce Wayne, in his film, *Batman Begins*.

Your response should draw on your knowledge and understanding of the module Literary Worlds and reference the selected extracts.

Text 1 — Nonfiction extracts

Christopher Edward Nolan, CBE (born 30 July 1970) is an English-American film director, screenwriter, and producer. He is known for making personal, distinctive films within the Hollywood mainstream and is regarded as an auteur.

- Wikipedia

Nolan admitted that he approached the comic-book world through a different lens, as a noir-thriller. “Yes, it’s a superhero, but it’s based on ideas of guilt, fear, these strong impulses that the character has,” Nolan said. “Bruce Wayne doesn’t have any super powers other than extraordinary wealth. But really, he’s just someone who does a lot of push-ups. In that sense, he’s very relatable and human. I think that’s why I gravitated towards it.”

Grounded in realism — grounded in heightened realism, grounded in the degree of realism that we expected at the time from, you know, our action movies, **Jerry Bruckheimer** action movies and things, that would have realistic textures, you know? So, “OK, let’s do that.” What I loved about *Superman* was the way New York felt like New York, or rather Metropolis felt like New York. Metropolis felt like a city you could recognize — and then there was this guy flying through the streets. “That’s amazing, so let’s do that for *Batman*, and let’s start by putting together an amazing cast,”

When asked if his “Batman” paid homage to James Bond, Nolan admitted a connection. “We mercilessly pillaged from the James Bond films for certain aspects,” Nolan said, adding that they wanted to make him as compelling as 007. He noted how Gotham’s chief inventor Lucius

Fox is similar to Bond's Agent Q, who has a closet full of gadgets. "But I think if I made my version of James Bond, 'Inception' is far more guilty of that than 'The Dark Knight,'" Nolan said.

To me, each film is a different genre," Nolan said, about the movies starring Christian Bale as Batman. "They tend to be defined by the villain."

**Christopher Nolan introduction (Wikipedia)
and extracts from various interviews**

Text 2 — Script extract

INT. CAVERNS - CONTINUOUS

Wayne climbs down a jagged rock crevice. Air blows in his face. The crevice widens into a low-ceilinged chamber. Wayne hears the rush of water. He crouches, advances through the low chamber. It turns downwards, steeper - Wayne carefully slides on his back, lowering himself into -

*Limitless black. Wayne stands. A roar of water now. He reaches into his coat, pulls out a chemical torch. Cracks it, throwing light into -
A vast cavern. An underground river, a jagged ceiling, far above, which, as Wayne peers, starts to move -*

Bats explode from the ceiling. Thousands descend, screeching, attracted to the light. Wayne instinctively crouches. But as they swarm around him terrifyingly -

Wayne rises to his feet amidst a cyclone of bats, watching the fluttering blackness with a profound calm.

And he knows the symbol he must use.

INT. MAIN HALL, WAYNE MANOR – CONTINUOUS

Hundreds of Guests. Music. Tables groaning with food.

WAYNE

Crane was working for you.

RĀ'S AL GHŪL

His toxin is derived from the organic compound in our blue poppies. He was able to weaponize it.

WAYNE

He's not a member of the League of Shadows

As guests filter out, a dozen of Rā's men remain, scattered around the room.

RĀ'S AL GHŪL

Of course not. He thought our plan was to hold the city to ransom.

WAYNE

But really you're going to unleash Crane's poison on the entire city . . .

RĀ'S AL GHŪL

Then watch Gotham tear itself apart through fear . . .

WAYNE

You're going to destroy millions of lives.

RĀ'S AL GHŪL

Only a cynical man would call what these people have 'lives', Wayne.

Rā's steps out of the main hall and into a corridor.

INT. CORRIDOR, WAYNE MANOR - CONTINUOUS

The corridor is long and dark, lined with books and windows.

Outside across the darkened hills: the glow of Gotham.

RĀ'S AL GHŪL

People stacked like boxes. Families sleeping in garbage. Crime. Despair. This is not how man was supposed to live.

Rā's al Ghūl gestures at the distant glow of Gotham.

The League of Shadows has been a check against human corruption for thousands of years. We sacked Rome. Loaded trade ships with plague rats. Burned London to the ground. Every time civilisation reaches the pinnacle of its decadence, we return to restore the balance.

WAYNE

Gotham isn't beyond saving. There are good people here, people who -

INT. CORRIDOR, WAYNE MANOR - CONTINUOUS

Rā's al Ghūl turns to Wayne.

RĀ'S AL GHŪL

You have no illusions about the world, Bruce. When I found you in that jail you were lost. But I believed in you. I took away your fear, and showed you a path. You were my greatest student . . . it should be you standing by my side, saving the world.

WAYNE

I'll be standing right where I am now - between you and the people of Gotham.

Rā's al Ghūl looks at Wayne, hard. A door closing.

BATMAN BEGINS

Co-written by Christopher Nolan and David S. Goyer

Section II: Electives

25 marks

Attempt Question 2

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

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Question 2

Elective 4: Literary Mindscapes (25 marks)

In times of great change, we are challenged to hold on to our identity or forge new ways of being and thinking.

To what extent do the texts that you have studied explore this idea in different ways? In your response, refer to TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

Note: Representations of the mind, including desires, motivations, emotions and memories, communicate notions of identity and alternative ways of being and thinking.

The prescribed texts for Section II are:

◆ Elective 1: Literary Homelands

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Aravind Adiga, *The White Tiger*
 - E M Forster, *A Passage to India*
 - Colm Tóibín, *Brooklyn*

- **Poetry**
 - Eileen Chong, *Burning Rice*

The prescribed poems are:

- * *Burning Rice*
- * *Mid-autumn Mooncakes*
- * *My Hakka Grandmother*
- * *Shophouse, Victoria Street*
- * *Chinese Ginseng*
- * *Winter Meeting*
- * *Singapore*

- **Drama** – Andrew Bovell, *The Secret River* [by Kate Grenville – An adaptation for the stage by Andrew Bovell]
- **Film** – Sarah Gavron, *Brick Lane*

◆ Elective 2: Worlds of Upheaval

- **Prose Fiction** – Elizabeth Gaskell, *North and South*
 - Mary Shelley, *Frankenstein*
 - Madeleine Thien, *Do Not Say We Have Nothing*
- **Poetry** – Seamus Heaney, *Opened Ground: Poems 1966–1996*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Digging*
 - * *The Strand at Lough Beg*
 - * *Casualty*
 - * *Funeral Rites*
 - * *Whatever You Say Say Nothing*
 - * *Triptych*
- **Drama** – Samuel Beckett, *Waiting for Godot*
- **Film** – Fritz Lang, *Metropolis*

◆ Elective 3: Reimagined Worlds

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Italo Calvino, *If on a Winter's Night a Traveller*
 - Ursula Le Guin, *The Left Hand of Darkness*
 - Jonathan Swift, *Gulliver's Travels*
- **Poetry**
 - Samuel Taylor Coleridge, *Samuel Taylor Coleridge: The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* (1834)
 - * *The Eolian Harp*
 - * *Kubla Khan*
 - * *Christabel*
 - Tracy K Smith, *Life on Mars*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Sci-Fi*
 - * *My God, It's Full of Stars*
 - * *Don't You Wonder, Sometimes?*
 - * *The Universe: Original Motion Picture Soundtrack*
 - * *The Universe as Primal Scream*
- **Film**
 - Guillermo Del Toro, *Pan's Labyrinth*

◆ Elective 4: Literary Mindscapes

- **Prose Fiction**
 - William Faulkner, *As I Lay Dying*
 - Gail Jones, *Sixty Lights*
 - Katherine Mansfield, *The Collected Stories*
 - * *Prelude*
 - * *Je ne Parle pas Français*
 - * *Bliss*
 - * *Psychology*
 - * *The Daughters of the Late Colonel*
- **Poetry**
 - Emily Dickinson, *The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *I felt a Funeral, in my Brain*
 - * *This is my letter to the World*
 - * *I died for Beauty – but was scarce*
 - * *I had been hungry, all the Years*
 - * *Because I could not stop for Death*
 - * *My Life has stood – a Loaded Gun*
 - * *A word dropped careless on a Page*
- **Drama**
 - William Shakespeare, *Hamlet*
- **Film**
 - Sofia Coppola, *Lost in Translation*

◆ Elective 5: Intersecting Worlds

- **Prose Fiction** – Melissa Harrison, *Clay*
 - Alex Miller, *Journey to the Stone Country*
 - Annie Proulx, *The Shipping News*
- **Nonfiction** – Tim Winton, *Island Home*
- **Poetry** – William Wordsworth, *William Wordsworth: The Major Works*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Lines written a few miles above Tintern Abbey*
 - * *Three years she grew in sun and shower*
 - * *My heart leaps up when I behold*
 - * *Resolution and Independence*
 - * *The world is too much with us*
 - * *Ode ('There was a time')*
 - * *The Solitary Reaper*
 - * *The Prelude* (1805) – Book One, lines 1–67, 271– 441
- **Film** – Daniel Nettheim, *The Hunter*

End of English Extension 1 Exam